

If you decide to make your own investment trades over the Internet, the following suggestions are ways for you to prepare yourself:

- Subscribe to a money magazine like *Young Money* (www.youngmoney.com) or *Better Investing*.
- Check out money websites like MSN Money (moneycentral.msn.com) and The Motley Fool (www.fool.com).
- Order materials that teach investing basics (click on “resource clearinghouse” at www.jumpstart.org).
- Enroll in finance classes offered in your high school or college.
- Attend money management programs offered by your church, your job, or your local community agency.
- Buy personal finance books that teach the basics of investing.

Trine chose risky investment funds as her next “business venture” without much research. Her decision to enter the world of hedge funds and private equity had been prompted by several newspaper articles that she had read which chronicled huge profits by several traders. After having read these articles, her decision was made. However, if she had done research on the risks and profitability of these types of investments, Trine may have chosen a different path.

Words of Wisdom

As we have seen, receiving any large sum of money is usually a mixed blessing, not the proverbial pot of gold at the end of the rainbow. Large or small, the use of any unusual income should be carefully analyzed so that you do not end up broke. And of course, for very significant sums, a professional advisor should be consulted.

